



INSTAGRAM: @ROUNAK_CHOUHAN27

Rounak Chouhan retains title



Top seed Rounak Chouhan edged out Gnana Dattu in a three-game final to retain his men's singles crown at the Kotak India Junior International Series in Hyderabad. After dropping the opening game 15-21, Rounak showed tremendous grit as he bounced back strongly to take the next two, completing a 15-21, 21-13, 21-13 win and repeating his title-winning run from last year.

In women's singles, third seed Shriyanshi Valishetty produced a dominant display to outclass Aikya Shetty 21-12, 21-8 and clinch the championship.

The men's doubles final delivered one of the day's biggest upsets, as the unseeded pair of Niranjana G. Nandakumar and Yudhajith Reddy Padigepati prevailed over top seeds Bhavya Chhabra and C. Lalramsanga 21-17, 14-21, 23-21.

In women's doubles, Deepak Raj Aditi and Ponnammamma B. V. Vriddhi defeated Keerthy Manchala and Varna Prabu Anand 21-13, 21-17 at the Kotak Pullela Gopichand Badminton Academy.

Vansh Dev and Shravani Walekar overcame the seeded duo of Mithileish P. Krishnan and Varna Prabu Anand 19-21, 21-16, 21-15 to win the mixed doubles crown.

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SPORTOON



1 The Inspire Institute of Sports (IIS) has stationed eight young judokas — boys and girls, mostly in the 18-20 age group — in Akhmeta, Georgia, for long-term high-performance training under head coach Mamuka Kizilashvili. The squad — Leishangthem Chanu, Linthoi Chanambam, Ishroop Narang, Yamini Mourya, Aditya Solanki, Arun Kumar, Sidharth Rawat, and Ningthoujam Sheetal Singh — is gaining exposure to a varied pool of training partners and opponents through regular club competitions. In addition, they will compete in international events from time to time.

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2 Arvind Iyer was crowned champion of the All India Chess Masters Mumbai FIDE Classical Tournament after he edged out Darsh Shetty in a strong competition. Arvind and Darsh finished with seven points each but the former won the championship on super Buchholz tie-breaks. International Master Vikramaditya Kulkarni finished third with 6.5 points. In women's category, Woman Candidate Master Kriti Mayur Patel was adjudged as the Best Player, followed by Reya Banker and Pradeepa Jayapal who took the second and third place respectively.

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